meesho SEASON 3 DICE CHALLENGE

BUSINESS TRACK · DETAILED SUBMISSION ROUND · 8–10 SLIDE DECK + WORKING PROTOTYPE

Building Meesho's Consumer-to-Manufacturer (C2M) Base

Screen on price, not scale. Pay for early conviction in impressions, not rupees. Make nothing until it is sold.

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Live prototype meesho-dice-c2m-iitb.vercel.app

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WHO, AND WHY NOT

Q1 · Manufacturer segmentation · Which cohorts do we go after first, and what stops each of them?

₹41,560 cr
FY26 NMV, +39% YoY

₹265
FY26 AOV, down 3% YoY

4.0%
Contribution margin, Q4 FY26 exit (2.3% in Q3)

9.6 lakh
Transacting sellers, +87% YoY

0%
Commission, now matched: Flipkart fashion at every price (8 Jul 2026)

264 mn
Annual transacting users, +33%

COHORT A · Offline-only, B2B bulk

72% of 11,645 ≈ 8,400 firms

PROFILE
Made to order, distributor-fed, zero returns, 45–60 day terms

BARRIER
No unit-level ops; build-to-stock is a balance-sheet change

MOTIVATION
Idle capacity; export shock (US tariff 50%, Aug–Dec 2025)

LEVER
Factory Node + demand-confirmed batches

COHORT B · Online, active elsewhere

19% of 11,645 ≈ 2,200 firms

PROFILE
On Amazon, Flipkart or own D2C; GST and catalogue done

BARRIER
₹800+ basket catalogue loses money at a ₹265 AOV

MOTIVATION
264 mn buyers and a Tier-2+ base it cannot reach elsewhere

LEVER
Price check + value-tier catalogue, not a discount

COHORT C · Churned from Meesho

9% of 11,645 ≈ 1,050 firms

PROFILE
Listed, exited inside two quarters; catalogue dormant

BARRIER
Weak first 30 orders, then an RTO or returns shock

MOTIVATION
Sunk catalogue cost; KYC and price history already exist

LEVER
Returns firewall + health-score re-entry

BARRIER SEVERITY × COHORT

from the 24-interview objection set

Barrier	A	B	C	Meesho can fix
Unit-level fulfilment	HIGH	LOW	MED	YES
Inventory risk, build-to-stock	HIGH	MED	HIGH	YES
Returns and RTO exposure	HIGH	MED	HIGH	YES
Unproven demand	HIGH	MED	HIGH	YES
Cash cycle, settlement lag	MED	LOW	MED	PART
Channel conflict, brand dilution	HIGH	HIGH	LOW	PART

Four of six barriers are HIGH for Cohort A and all four are fixable with infrastructure. Brand dilution at a ₹265 AOV is not fixable, which is why Cohort B gets a separate value-tier catalogue rather than a discount.

FIELD EVIDENCE · TIRUPPUR, THE PILOT CLUSTER

3,200
knitwear manufacturers

₹74,747 cr
FY26 output; ₹44,747 cr exported, ≈₹30,000 cr domestic

−60 to −70%
US orders under the 50% tariff, Aug–Dec 2025

750–1,000
units shut; tariff now 18%, plus an India–EU trade deal

So what: the export shock proved the motivation, and the rollback is closing the window. Pilot now, and sell C2M as a permanent hedge, not a rescue.

RESEARCH DESIGN · METHODS, COVERAGE

Method	n	Output
Manufacturer interviews, 3 cohorts	8 each	Objection set, barrier grid
Cluster walk-throughs	2	Cost Ownership Index
Platform teardown: fees, feed, panel	4 cats	Landed-price medians
Filings, earnings calls, Udyam, cluster studies	15+	FY26 baseline, addressable base
Global C2M teardowns	7 · 5 mkts	Copy / avoid library
Round 2 fact-check: results, earnings call, Reuters, trade press	20+	Corrected margin, precedents
Prototype simulation (synthetic, seeded)	261 · 4,415 SKUs	Rules tested end to end

DELIBERATELY NOT NOW

Fashion-led ethnic wear, Surat
India's largest textile cluster (₹1 lakh cr+) ranks last on our cluster AHP (3.28): traders job out weaving, dyeing and stitching, and it sits in the worst return band.

Electronics accessories, import-assembly
No cost ownership, so any price gap has to be funded, and a funded gap is a subsidy with a different name.

Sources: Meesho FY26 results and Q4 FY26 earnings call (6 May 2026); Flipkart newsroom (8 Jul 2026); Udyam Registration Portal; The Federal, Deccan Herald (Tiruppur, 2025–26); team interviews (n = 24). Cohort shares of the 11,645 addressable base.

Start with Cohort A in Tiruppur and Panipat: its barriers are operational, and operational barriers are the only ones Meesho can remove with infrastructure instead of subsidy.

HOW BIG, HOW CHEAP

Q2 · Market sizing and opportunity · How big is the base, and what does closing the price gap do for buyers and NMV?

ADDRESSABLE BASE · BOTTOM-UP

4.72 cr	Udyam-registered MSMEs, 98.9% micro	
5.28 lakh	above micro (small + medium)	1.1%
1.85 lakh	in manufacturing	35%
55,451	making Meesho's categories	30%
19,408	own ≥ 3 of 4 cost levers (COI)	35%
11,645	inside the 12 screened clusters	60%
1,400	**active C2M sellers by Year 4**	**12%**

Right-hand figure = conversion from the row above. COI = Cost Ownership Index: raw material, production, scale, automation.

OPPORTUNITY LADDER · PRICE AND NMV IMPACT

	Pilot · Day 90	Scale · Q2+	Target · Year 4
Clusters · Factory Nodes	2 · 1	5 · 6	12 · 12
Active C2M sellers	60	450	1,400
Run-rate NMV	**₹86 cr**	**₹641 cr**	**₹1,995 cr**
Share of FY26 NMV	0.2%	1.5%	4.8%
Buyer savings / yr, gap 8–12%	**₹7.4–₹12 cr**	**₹56–₹87 cr**	**₹173–₹272 cr**
Contribution at 4.0% CM	₹3.4 cr	₹26 cr	₹80 cr

Buyer savings = NMV × g ÷ (1 − g) · g from the 8% gate floor to 12%, the low end of the 12–18% cost edge integration buys. Contribution uses the 4.0% Q4 FY26 exit rate.

4.8%
of FY26 NMV becomes structurally cheaper

₹173–272
₹ cr a year returned to buyers

₹80 cr
contribution a year at today's margin

WHY NOW · THE RATE-CARD MOAT IS GONE

Apr 2025	Nov 2025	Nov 2025	Mar 2026	8 Jul 2026
Amazon: no referral fee < ₹300	Flipkart: 0% < ₹1,000; Shopsy 0%	Amazon: 0% referral < ₹1,000	Amazon expands zero fees	Flipkart: 0% on all fashion, any price

Fees converge to zero. The only price advantage a competitor's rate card cannot copy is a cost-structure advantage.

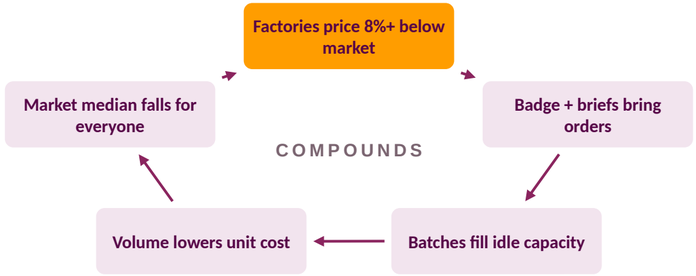
WHERE TO PILOT · CLUSTER AHP

Cluster	Cost	Dem	Ret	Node	Inst	Score
Tiruppur	5	5	4	4	5	4.68
Panipat	5	4	5	4	4	4.52
Ludhiana	4	3	4	4	4	3.74
Rajkot	4	3	5	3	3	3.70
Surat	2	5	2	5	3	3.28

Criteria: cost ownership, demand on Meesho, returns band, node feasibility, institutional partner (association).

Surat passes a scale screen and fails the price screen. Pilot where cost ownership, low returns and an association to recruit through coincide: Tiruppur (hosiery) and Panipat (home textiles).

10X · THE C2M FLYWHEEL



Every lap lowers the median resellers are measured against. The price edge compounds instead of being paid for.

Sources: Udyam Registration Portal (team pull; 7.83 cr incl. Udyam Assist, PIB Feb 2026); Meesho FY26 results; Flipkart, Amazon, Business Standard, Outlook Business (2025–26); Round 1 cluster AHP and teardown. Run-rate NMV assumes the Round 1 Year-4 yield of ₹1.43 cr per seller.

11,645 manufacturers in 12 clusters can carry a real price gap. Capturing 12% by Year 4 adds ₹1,995 cr of NMV priced at least 8% below today's market: ₹173 cr to ₹272 cr a year back to buyers.

WHERE PRICE IS REAL

Q3 · Which manufacturers and categories carry a genuine, defensible price advantage, and which do not despite scale?

CATEGORY SCREEN · 12 SCREENED, 9 IN SCOPE

Category	Cluster	Floor	Idle	Ret.	Frt.
Unstitched saree & dress material	Erode, Bhiwandi	✓	✓	✓	✓
Home textiles: sheets, towels	Panipat, Solapur	✓	✓	✓	–
Hosiery, innerwear, socks	Tiruppur, Ludhiana	✓	–	✓	✓
Moulded plastic housewares	Rajkot, Daman	✓	✓	✓	–
Imitation jewellery	Rajkot, Coimbatore	✓	✓	–	✓
Steel kitchenware, utensils	Jagadhri, Wazirpur	✓	–	✓	–
Basic footwear, PU/EVA	Agra, Bahadurgarh	✓	✓	–	✓
Brass décor & lighting	Moradabad	✓	×	✓	–
Bags, school bags	Nangloi, Kolkata	–	✓	–	✓
Ethnic wear	Surat (largest)	×	✓	×	✓
Fitted western, jeans	Gandhi Nagar, Bengaluru	–	✓	×	✓
Electronics accessories	import-assembly	×	✓	–	✓

Floor = cost floor below the market median · Idle = spare capacity · Ret. = low return band · Frt. = freight per rupee of value. Rows 10–12 fail two tests: not now.

PRICE TRUTH INDEX · THE SCREEN

Comparable-set median

Order-weighted landed price on delivered orders, per product type. SKUs need ≥ 10 orders.

SKU price gap

gap = (median − seller landed price) ÷ median

Dominant-seller fix

A seller with > 30% of a set's orders is scored against the median without its own orders.

Catalogue gate

≥ 8% gap on ≥ 60% of live SKUs, sellers above ₹5 cr GMV. One loss-leader cannot buy the badge.

Badge + re-rank, with a holdout

Matched control, read at Day 30 (see Roadmap).

BIGGER IS NOT CHEAPER · FROM THE WORKING PROTOTYPE

Bigger is not cheaper

Each dot is a seller above ₹5 cr. Height is the median price gap of its live SKUs against the comparable-set median. Click a dot to inspect it.

Correlation between seller size and price gap is -0.18: among large sellers, more GMV does not mean a lower shelf price. 7 of the 10 largest sellers fail the gate.

180	62 · 34%	84 · 47%	r = -0.18
sellers above ₹5 cr screened	pass the gate	scale without price	size vs price gap

What the screen catches that a turnover filter misses

- 7 of the 10 largest sellers carry no real price edge: they are traders, and scale never became price.
- 18 catalogues had 2–3 SKUs 20%+ below market and the rest at market: the gate refuses them.
- 16 near misses have a real but thin edge: the Factory Node closes it (see Onboarding).

WHY CATEGORY BEATS SCALE · THE RETURN MATH

Return cost per unit kept	at ₹90 / return	at ₹150 / return
30% returns (fitted ethnic)	₹39 · 14.6% of AOV	₹64 · 24.3% of AOV
5% returns (home textiles)	₹5 · 1.8% of AOV	₹8 · 3.0% of AOV
Gap between the two categories	**13 pp of AOV**	**21 pp of AOV**

Returns × fee ÷ units kept. A wrong category swallows the whole 12–18% cost edge before a buyer sees it. ₹90 is our estimate; ₹150 is the seller-guide rate for ≤ 500 g.

FOUR VERDICTS, FOUR ACTIONS

Verdict	Action
C2M-ready (62)	Badge + re-rank + Demand Brief
Scale without price (84)	No badge; offer a value-tier catalogue
Loss-leader pattern (18)	No badge; the catalogue gate holds
Near miss (16)	Factory Node cost help; re-score in 28 days

Sources: Round 1 segment scorecard and platform teardown; seller-guide return fees (Shiprocket, Robnu, 2026). Prototype figures come from synthetic, seeded data (fictional sellers) and demonstrate the method, not Meesho's actual distribution.

Screen on price, not size: badge a catalogue only when ≥ 60% of its live SKUs sit ≥ 8% below the comparable-set median. In the prototype, 7 of the 10 largest sellers fail that test.

Q4 · Onboarding model · Support stack, risk-sharing and assisted operations for reluctant manufacturers

THE MADE-TO-MEESHO FLOW · ONE MANUFACTURER, END TO END

numbers from the working prototype

1 · Price check
Lowest price at 9% margin ₹213 vs ₹245 median: 13.3% below, qualifies before listing

2 · Demand Brief
12 districts, 15,630 orders a week, price band and size mix; first batch 1,900 units

3 · Batch window
Buyers pre-order (ships in 7 days); 1,052 confirmed, make 1,210 (+15% buffer)

4 · Bulk handover
One drop at the cluster Factory Node; 30% of confirmed value, ₹67,223, paid at handover

5 · Node runs unit ops
Pick, pack, ship each order; returns terminate at the node, not the factory

6 · Settlement
Balance 7 days after delivery: cash in ~11 days vs 50 on distributor terms

EVERY BARRIER HAS A LEVER · COVERAGE

Barrier	Price check	Demand Brief	Batch window	Factory Node	Returns firewall	Prepay
Unit-level fulfilment				✓		
Inventory risk		–	✓			–
Returns and RTO	–			✓	✓	
Unproven demand		✓	✓			
Cash cycle				–		✓
Channel conflict	✓	–				

✓ removes · – reduces. The price check prices returns in; the node cuts reverse cost; the firewall caps the rest.

SUPPORT STACK BY COHORT

A — Offline B2B
Cluster co-op onboarding (40–60 at a time) · price check · briefs · batch window · Factory Node · 30% prepayment

B — Online elsewhere
Price check → separate value-tier SKUs (not a discount) · briefs · may self-ship

C — Churned
Returns firewall (capped exposure) · health-score re-entry · catalogue and KYC reused

PRECEDENT · WHAT WE COPY, WHAT WE AVOID

Platform	Mechanic	Result
Copy · Pinduoduo	Anonymised demand data to factories (New Brand Initiative)	900+ factories, 2,200+ custom SKUs, 115 mn orders by end-2019
Copy · Temu	Semi-managed: bulk to local warehouses, platform runs storefront	Targeted 60–80% of US GMV in 2025
Avoid · Shein Brazil	Demanded ~30% price cuts and faster delivery from factories	336 signed vs 2,000 target; 1 still producing (Reuters, Feb 2026)

Lesson: fix the operating model and measure the gap that already exists. Never ask a factory for a price cut.

ASSISTED OPERATIONS · WHAT THE FACTORY NODE BUYS (₹98 COST, 9% MARGIN)

	Lowest viable price	Below market median	Return cost / unit kept	Margin at ₹221	C2M badge
Ship each order yourself	₹219	10.8%	₹8	10.0%	✓ yes
Factory Node	**₹213**	**13.3%**	**₹6**	**12.5%**	✓ yes

Working capital: 2.5% of revenue on 50-day distributor terms vs 0.6% on a prepaid batch (18% cost of capital). Node rates are proposal assumptions (src/config.js).

RISK-SHARING · WHO CARRIES WHAT

Risk	B2B today	Made-to-Meesho
Unsold stock	None: made to order	**Only the 15% buffer on confirmed orders**
Returns handling	None	**Node absorbs it; firewall pool caps the loss**
Waiting for cash	45–60 days	**30% at handover; rest ~7 days after delivery**
Demand	Distributor orders	**Pre-orders plus the pin-code brief**

Sources: prototype manufacturer app (illustrative seller Kavin Knit Mills, fictional; ₹98 making cost; assumptions in src/config.js); Reuters via FashionNetwork (Feb 2026); KrASIA (Pinduoduo, 2019 data); Tech Buzz China (Temu, 2025).

Keep the B2B risk model: price-check before listing, show demand by pin-code, make only what is pre-ordered, and hand over in bulk to a Factory Node that runs unit operations.

KEEPING THEM

Q5 · Sustainable scale-up · Early order conviction and retention, without subsidy or handholding

THE COLD-START GAP, IN MEESHO'S OWN WORDS

"If their quality is not that great, they do not get visibility for orders. And products that have very good quality continue to scale on the platform."

— Vidit Aatrey, CEO, Q4 FY26 earnings call, 6 May 2026

Implication: a new factory needs orders to prove quality and quality to earn orders. That loop, not price, is why new sellers take a small share of orders in their first 30 days.

IMPRESSIONS, NOT RUPEES · THE GRANT

12
Demand Brief pin-codes get starter impressions

+25K
impressions for 7 days if orders < 60% at D7/D14

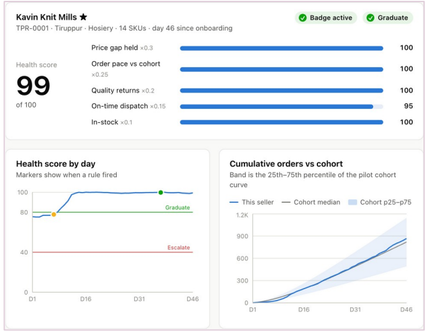
max 2
grants per seller

≤ 20%
of category impressions, hard cap

CONVICTION, THEN RETENTION · WHAT FIRES, WHEN, AND WHAT WE WATCH

Stage	When	What Meesho does, automatically	Trigger	Seller sees	KPI
Qualify	Day 0	Badge on; re-rank inside the category	Passed the price gate	C2M badge	Gap at onboarding
Allocate	D0–D14	Starter impressions in the 12 Demand Brief pin-codes	Onboarding	First orders where demand is	Orders vs cohort curve
Allocate	D7, D14	+25K impressions for 7 days (max 2 grants)	Orders < 60% of cohort median	WhatsApp: grant applied	Recovery by D21
Diagnose	Daily	Health Score from five signals (see Metrics)	Every day	Weekly score card	Score 0–100
Remedy	On trigger	Price nudge · QC hold · node offer · restock nudge	8 rule thresholds	One specific fix	Time to recover
Graduate	D30+	Batch prepayment unlocked	Score ≥ 80 for 30 days	Cheaper working capital	Graduation rate
Retain	D60+	Weekly brief refresh; prepaid batches each cycle; Meesho Mall path	Graduated, gap held	Steady demand, fast cash	Active at D90
Human	Exception	Category manager reviews	Score < 40 for 7 days after a fix	A call	≤ 5 per 100 / month

ONE SELLER · KAVIN KNIT MILLS (FICTIONAL), TIRUPPUR



Day 0
Badge on; first batch handed over at the node
Day 7
Orders at D7 were 41% of the cohort median (floor 60%): a grant fires, no one calls
Day 8+
Orders recover into the cohort band; score ≥ 80
Day 37
Graduated: batch prepayment unlocked

SCALES TO HUNDREDS WITHOUT HEADCOUNT

90 : 3
automated vs human actions

~910
sellers per category manager

Sellers per manager = capacity ÷ escalation rate = 40 ÷ (3 ÷ 68 seller-months) ≈ 910. The 3 escalations are the only human touches in the pilot.

EXPLICITLY REJECTED

Option	Why not
Order subsidy or paid boosts	Buys volume, not conviction; stops the day funding stops
Account managers per seller	Works at 20 sellers, breaks at 200, cannot reach 1,400
Onboarding by turnover	The brief's own diagnosis: scale is not price
Weakening the quality gate	Protects nobody; grants target traffic, not ranking rules

Sources: Meesho Q4 FY26 earnings call transcript (6 May 2026); prototype Seller Health module (synthetic 60-seller pilot, fixed seed). The category-manager capacity of 40 escalation reviews a month is an assumption.

Pay for early conviction in impressions, not rupees, and let rules fix what the Health Score flags: 90 automated actions to 3 escalations, ~910 sellers per category manager.

WHAT WE WATCH

Q6 · Metrics and KPIs · What Meesho tracks across onboarding, activation and retention, and when it steps in

KPI TREE · ONBOARDING → ACTIVATION → RETENTION

NORTH STAR · PRICE-COMPETITIVE C2M NMV
NMV from sellers whose catalogue still clears the ≥ 8% gate

ONBOARDING	ACTIVATION	RETENTION
Qualified → listed ≥ 50% in 30 days	**Orders at D7 / D14** ≥ 60% of cohort median	**Active at D90** ≥ 75%
Days to first live listing ≤ 7	**First-30-day orders** ≥ cohort p50 for 70%	**Gate retention D14 / D30** ≥ 70% still clear
First batch committed ≤ 14 days	**Days to 10th order** ≤ 10	**Graduated by D60** ≥ 40%

GUARDRAILS (programme level)
Category NMV ≥ pre-period · badged ≤ 20% of category impressions · quality returns ≤ 1.5× norm · escalations ≤ 5 per 100 sellers a month

C2M SELLER HEALTH SCORE · 0–100, DAILY

30%	25%	20%	15%	10%

- **Price gap held** today's gap ÷ gap at onboarding
- **Order pace** 14-day orders ÷ cohort median (0.3 → 0, 1.0 → 100)
- **Quality returns** ≤ 1× category norm = 100, 2× = 0
- **On-time dispatch** 7-day SLA: 80% → 0, 97% → 100
- **In-stock** live SKUs in stock: 50% → 0, 95% → 100

≥ 80 for 30 days
Graduate: prepayment unlocked

< 40 for 7 days after a fix
Escalate to a category manager

WHEN TO INTERVENE · THE RULEBOOK (9 AUTOMATIC, 1 HUMAN)

Signal and threshold	Action	Signal and threshold	Action
Orders < 60% of cohort median at D7 / D14	Impression grant (+25K, 7 days, max 2)	On-time dispatch < 90% over 7 days	Offer Factory Node operations
Price gap < 8% for 7 days	Price-drift nudge with market median	In-stock < 70% for 3 days	Restock nudge sized by the Demand Brief
Price gap < 4% for 3 days	Badge removed; re-entry after 7 days ≥ 8%	Score ≥ 80 for 30 days	Graduate: batch prepayment
Quality returns > 1.5× norm (≥ 30 deliveries)	Badge suspended + QC checklist	Score < 40 for 7 days after a fix	**Human: category manager**

LIVE IN THE PROTOTYPE · 60 PILOT SELLERS TODAY

Allocate	Diagnose	Remedy	Graduate
6	17	12	25

Average score 90 · 90 automated actions and 3 escalations so far. Remedy (amber) means an automatic fix is running; 3 of those sellers are with a person.

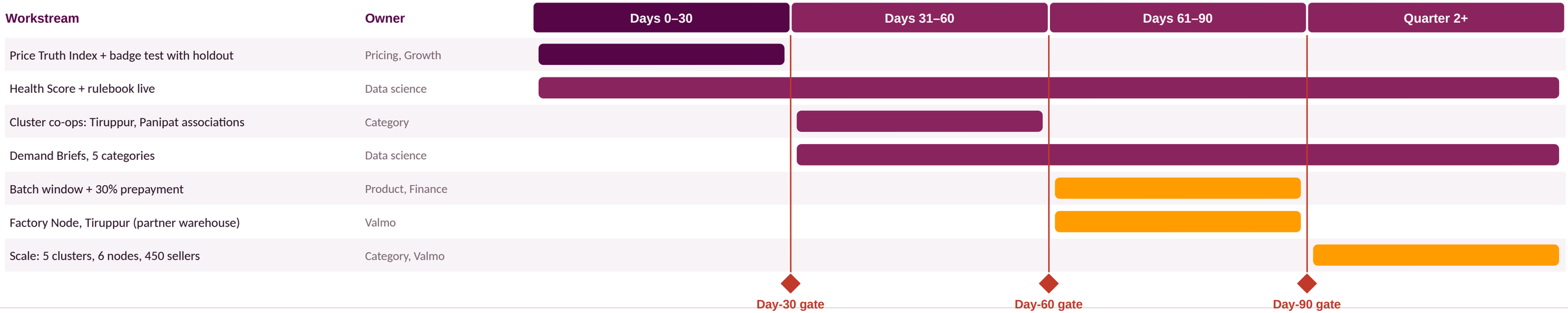
Targets are proposed pilot thresholds, to be recalibrated on the first cohort. Health Score weights and rule thresholds are the ones running in the prototype (src/config.js).

Measure the funnel from qualified to graduated, score every seller daily, and act at fixed thresholds; a person steps in only after an automatic fix has failed.

WHEN AND HOW MUCH

Q7 · 30-60-90 roadmap · What happens in the first 90 days, which numbers release the money, and what does it cost?

30-60-90 PILOT, THEN SCALE · WORKSTREAMS, OWNERS AND GATES

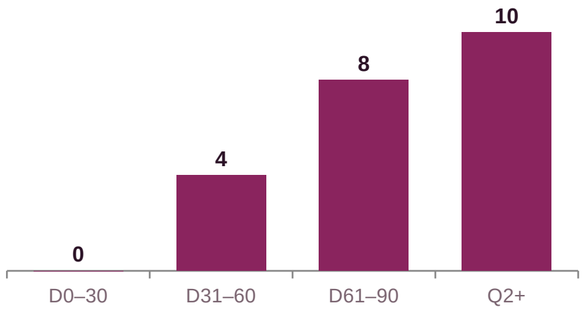


WHAT RELEASES THE MONEY · GATES

Gate	Pass when	If not
Day 30	Badged NMV per live SKU ≥ 12% over holdout, interval above zero, and ≥ 70% of badged sellers still clear at D14	Lift < 12%: tighten to a 10% gap and re-run. Decay or no lift: stop
Day 60	2 associations signed · 60 Cohort A factories catalogued · briefs live for 5 categories	Hold node spend; extend recruitment
Day 90	3 of 4: batches inside SLA · returns end at the node · gap retention ≥ 70% · category NMV ≥ baseline	Fix the failing number before Q2 scale

Prototype check: base scenario +18.2% with 87% retained → fund · weak +4.7% → tighten · decay 40% retained → stop. All three branches fire as specified.

SPEND BY HORIZON · ₹ CR



₹0 capex until the price gap is proven. Cumulative ₹22 cr in Year 1.
No new team: Pricing, Growth, Category and Valmo own existing workstreams.

YEAR-1 COST AND RETURN

Lever	Year-1 cost
Price gate, Health Score	₹0
Cluster co-op onboarding	₹5 cr
Demand Briefs	₹6 cr
Factory Node (partner)	₹8 cr
Returns firewall pool	₹3 cr
Batch prepayment	float only
Total	**₹22 cr**

+₹156 cr
NPV at 12% (Round 1 model)

Year 3
breakeven

₹80 cr
contribution a year by Year 4 at 4.0% CM

MSME-TEAM (₹277 cr national scheme) could co-fund cluster onboarding.

Sources: Round 1 RICE costing and NPV model (12% discount rate); prototype Day-30 readout (synthetic). MSME-TEAM: Ministry of MSME / ONDC, ₹277 cr over three years (Inc42); eligibility for Meesho to be confirmed.

Spend nothing until the price gap is proven: ₹0 capex to Day 30, ₹12 cr by Day 90 only if the Day-30 gate says fund, and ₹22 cr in Year 1 for a programme the Round 1 model values at NPV + ₹156 cr.

Q8 · Risks and guardrails · What could go wrong, how is each risk guarded, and where does C2M take Meesho in five years?

RISK REGISTER · EARLY SIGNAL AND BUILT-IN GUARDRAIL

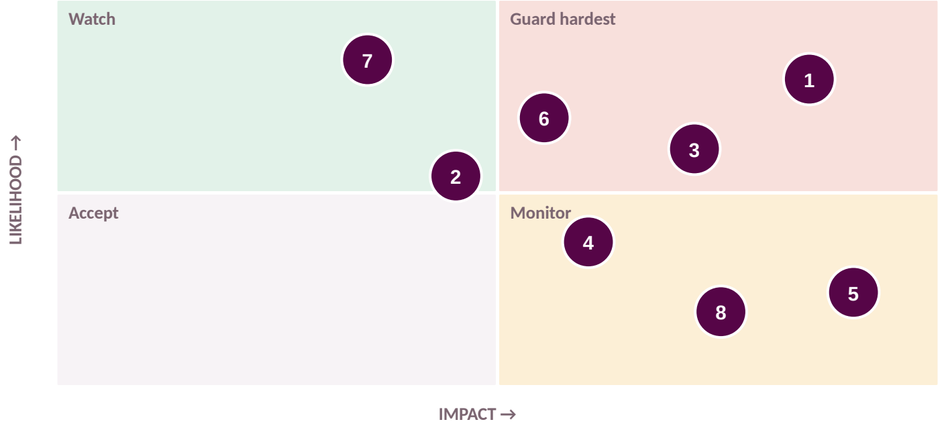
#	Risk	Early signal	Guardrail	Owner
1	**The price gap was a promotion**	Gate retention < 70% at D14	Day-30 stop rule; badge off at < 4% gap	Pricing
2	**Loss-leader SKUs game the badge**	2–3 SKUs 20%+ below, rest at market	Catalogue gate: ≥ 60% of live SKUs	Pricing
3	**Quality falls with price**	Quality returns > 1.5× norm	Suspend + QC; reinstate at ≤ 1.2× for 7 days	Category
4	**Re-rank starves existing resellers**	Category NMV vs pre-period	Badged ≤ 20% of category impressions	Growth
5	**Capex before demand**	Batch fill rate, node utilisation	No node before the Day-30 and Day-60 gates; partner warehouses first	Valmo
6	**Export recovery pulls factories back**	Tariff 50% → 18%; India–EU deal	Batches fill idle capacity around export runs; C2M as hedge	Category
7	**Rate-card war escalates**	Flipkart 0% on all fashion (Jul 2026)	Compete on cost structure (node, briefs), not fees	Strategy
8	**Shein-style squeeze drives factories away**	Attrition after price asks	Never ask for a price cut; the gate measures the gap that exists	Leadership

Why risk 8 matters: Shein pledged $150 mn for 2,000 Brazilian factories and asked for ~30% price cuts; 336 signed and 1 is still producing. Our screen only rewards a gap that already exists.

ASSUMPTIONS WE STILL HAVE TO VERIFY · BEFORE ANY CAPEX

Assumption	Value used	How we verify	By
Seller fee per customer return	₹90 (team estimate) to ₹150 (seller guides)	Pull from three live supplier panels	Day 7
Factory Node handling and forward cost	₹9 + ₹42 per unit (proposal)	Partner-warehouse quotes, Tiruppur	Day 45
Pre-order uptake at ₹20 off, 7-day delivery	55–70% of the suggested batch	A/B test in brief pin-codes	Day 60
Order lift while a grant is active	1.35× (simulation)	Holdout on the grant rule	Day 30

LIKELIHOOD × IMPACT



THE 10X PATH · FROM PILOT TO SUPPLY ENGINE

Year 5+ — **Factory brands on Meesho Mall**
"Value brands … for a billion people" (Aatrey): graduates brand their own lines

Year 4 — **12 clusters · 1,400 sellers · ₹1,995 cr**
4.8% of FY26 NMV structurally cheaper

Year 2 — **5 clusters · 6 nodes**
Briefs and batches become the default onboarding path

Year 1 — **2 clusters · 60 → 450 sellers**
Prove the gap at ₹0 capex; gate the money

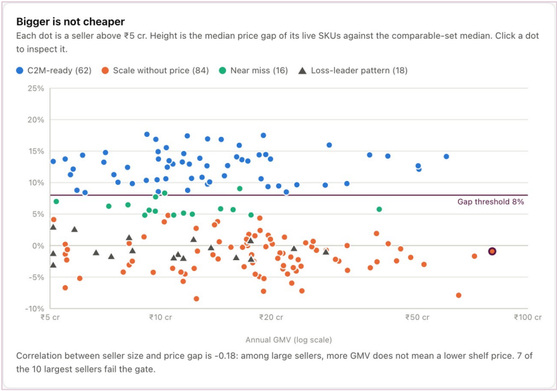
Sources: Meesho Q4 FY26 earnings call (Meesho Mall remarks, 6 May 2026); Reuters via FashionNetwork (Shein Brazil, Feb 2026); Flipkart newsroom (Jul 2026); The Federal (Tiruppur tariff rollback, 2026); KrASIA (Pinduoduo).

Every risk has a tripwire in the rulebook. The long game: graduated factories become Meesho Mall value brands, the path Pinduoduo's C2M opened for 900+ factories.

IT RUNS

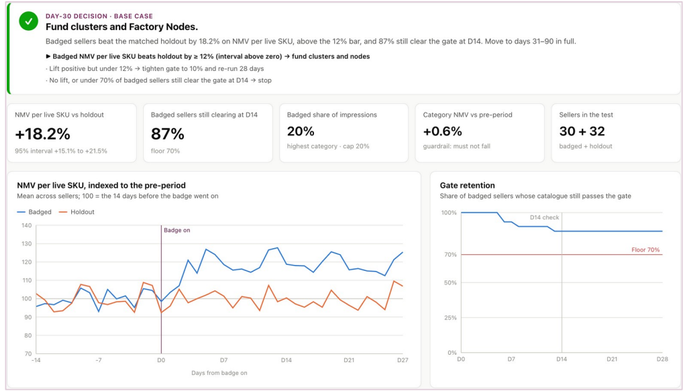
Q9 · Does it actually work? The working prototype, live

1 · PRICE TRUTH INDEX



180 screened · 62 pass · 7 of the 10 largest fail

2 · DAY-30 READOUT



Base +18.2% (CI +15.1% to +21.5%) → fund · weak +4.7% → tighten · decay 40% retained → stop

OPEN IT

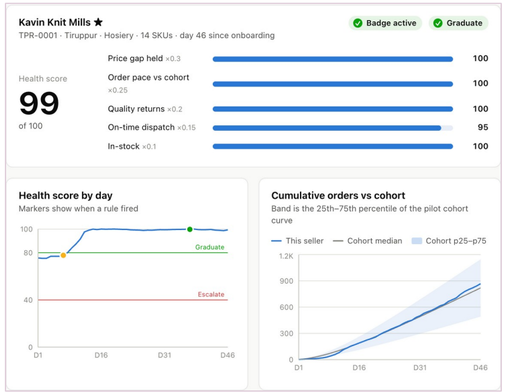
meesho-dice-c2m-iitb.vercel.app

Mirror:

prathmesh-28.github.io/c2m-control-tower

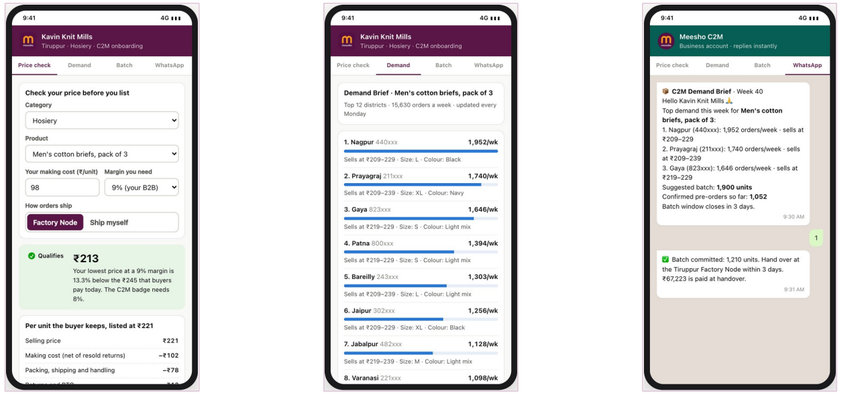
Offline: one HTML file, no internet needed

3 · SELLER HEALTH



60 sellers scored daily · 90 automated : 3 human · Kavin graduates on D37

4 · MANUFACTURER APP



Price check ₹213 vs ₹245 → brief → batch of 1,210 → one-tap WhatsApp commit

HOW MEESHO WOULD RUN IT

Feed	Used for
Catalogue: SKU, product type, landed price	Median, gate, badge
Orders: delivered, NMV, RTO, return reason	Brief, experiment, quality
Operations: dispatch time, stock	Health Score, remedies
Exposure: impressions by pin-code	Grants, 20% cap

One daily batch job plus event-driven rules. No new data integration.

Built for this submission: React + Recharts, static site. 261 synthetic sellers and 4,415 SKUs across 9 categories, a 60-seller pilot, fixed seed, fictional names. Four model tests run before every deploy. All assumptions live in one config file.

The prototype runs the whole loop on synthetic data (screen, experiment, daily score, manufacturer app), and every rule in it would run unchanged on Meesho's delivered-order and listing tables.